

Diamond Scholar — Pixel Artist Inquiry

Project: Kids' baseball learning game (web + PWA). Needs a chibi pixel-art batter with an 8-frame swing animation. Style inspired by *Baseball 9* and *Half-Yard Baseball*.

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What I Need

Character	Right-handed chibi baseball batter, royal blue helmet + jersey (#1F3A93), cream pants, wood bat, jersey number "9" on the back
Animation	8-frame swing sequence — body rotates ~90° clockwise (catcher-cam POV) from stance to full follow-through
Frame size	128×128, 192×192, or 256×256 — your call based on your workflow
Format	8 individual PNGs (or single horizontal sprite sheet), transparent background, no anti-aliasing
Source	Layered source file (Aseprite preferred) so I can request edits later

The 8 Frames

1. **Stance** — bat cocked over right shoulder, face visible, calm ready pose
2. **Load** — weight shifts back, hands draw back, bat tips more vertical
3. **Stride** — front foot plants, hips open, hands/bat STILL back (separation)
4. **Initiation** — hands drop forward, bat falls to ~45°, body ~45% rotated
5. **Contact** — bat horizontal extended toward pitcher, back foot on toe (money frame)
6. **Extension** — arms past lead shoulder, "9" coming into view
7. **Wrap** — bat wrapping toward left shoulder, full back visible
8. **Finish** — bat fully wrapped, hands high, full back with "9" centered

Critical: feet stay anchored at the same pixel position across all 8 frames — only the body rotates and limbs move. No drift.

Camera Angle

Catcher-cam — behind home plate looking out toward the pitcher. Right-handed batter in the left batter's box. We start seeing his back-right side with a sliver of his face; we end seeing his full back.

Questions for You

1. Frame size preference?
2. Aseprite, Photoshop, or other?
3. Turnaround for 8 frames + base character?
4. Quote (per-frame or fixed-price)?
5. Examples of comparable swing/action animations you've done?

If this looks like a fit, I'll send the **full brief** with detailed pose descriptions, character design specs, palette swatches, and reference images.

Thanks for taking a look.